were still incarcerated, they were accompanied with an order that the pleas of the fifteen accused should be recorded the next day, but on 11 July 1930 even the pleas of the accused were dispensed with. So now not only was the attendance of the accused dispensed with, but so were their pleas. They had no lawyer in court either fighting their corner for them. The extent of coercive legal control from the courtroom in this judicial reprisal only helps show how draconian the Lahore Ordinance III of 1930 was.

After a month's incarceration in solitary confinement, in the scorching heat of a Lahore jail,[10] one detainee, Kanwal Nath Tiwari, had even gone quite mad. But it was still deemed appropriate to dispense with both his plea and his attendance in court, such was the complete disregard with the elementary principles of criminal justice, as the special tribunal scurried towards ending the proceedings and handing down a sentence of death on three of the accused. No person in such a situation could have the ordinance invoked against them, unless achieving a conviction of the accused was all that the tribunal had in mind, in the six months allocated to it before it became defunct. The tribunal soldiered on remorselessly. A stream of witnesses was called by the prosecution in quick succession as they whirled into the witness box to confirm the events of 17 December 1928, to the prosecution's blatant delight. Confident students, like Som Nath, Abnash Chand and Aftab Ahmad, meandered in and out, to confirm how as witnesses to the day in question they had been residing in the hostel at DAV College. The apprehensive Ajmer Singh ambled in to explain how he had tenaciously hung on to his bicycle when the accused attempted to wrestle it off him, as they hurriedly scuttled off into hiding after entering the precincts of DAV College. All went unchallenged as witnesses, their evidence indisputable and undisputed.

All gave their evidence in the glaring absence of the accused. The accused were not there because some of the accused could not attend as they were medically unfit to do so, while others were on hunger strike in prison and others simply dispensed with in their attendance. On 7 October 1930, with the parody of the trial complete, the special tribunal announced its verdict. Des Raj, Jatinder Nath Sanyal and Ajoy Kumar Ghosh were the